Review of the exhibition *Silver Surfing*

4/12 - 21/12/2025 at /dkp/, Slovakia

Artist: Michaela Moravčíková

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This write-up discusses Moravcikova's latest exhibition in Bratislava, titled *Silver Surfing*, at the gallery /DKP/. The exhibition consists of black-and-white paintings made with acrylic paint as well as woodcut prints. The exhibition took place from December 4 to December 21, 2025.

The last two years can be considered the black-and-white era of the painter. The artist's experimentation began with smaller formats on paper executed in ink and watercolor. However, the works exhibited in this show demonstrate a clear breakthrough in the artist's visual language. These first black-and-white works explored the concept of playfulness and its role in abstraction, and consisted of various, predominantly subtle formats. For the first time, the artist constrains herself to a single, coherent format across the body of work, and this allows her to explore the medium of painting on a broader scale.

By focusing on monochromatic paint instead of color, the artist investigates a specific way of creating space between the layers of her paintings, akin to recursive, self-similar structures of tessellations that offer an endless pursuit of perception. While the audience follows serendipitous paths to trace the infinite dimensions and planes present in the paintings. Nevertheless, the paintings are stark and they imprint into the seer's imagination; they offer the familiar feeling of exploration, not because the space in the paintings is vacuously asserted, but because the state of unease caused by this space is familiar in the viewer's unconscious psyche. This unconscious exploration is parallel to that of the Silver Surfer; the strokes made by the artist resemble marks embroidered into the fabric of space by the Silver Surfer.

Interestingly, the nuanced interaction of the planes can only be perceived under specific lighting conditions, and the photos taken of the paintings fail to accurately represent their depth. Only direct, physical light reveals the essence of the works. The planes transforming under light create a temporally unique interlocking between the viewer and the painting, prompting the viewer to question the temporality of their own qualia. These reasons make the exhibition more than a routine visit because the experience cannot be digitally or infinitely reproduced. Another reason for a visit is to see how the artist intervenes in the gallery space. She creates a mesh of black stripes which partitions the gallery space and anchors and accentuates the paintings.